



## About Mandarin

Mandarin Chinese is a group of similar Chinese language dialects spoken in the northern and southwestern regions of China. Since one of the dialects is spoken in Beijing, Mandarin Chinese is China's official language. Mandarin is distinctive from the other Chinese languages in phonology, timing and vocabulary.

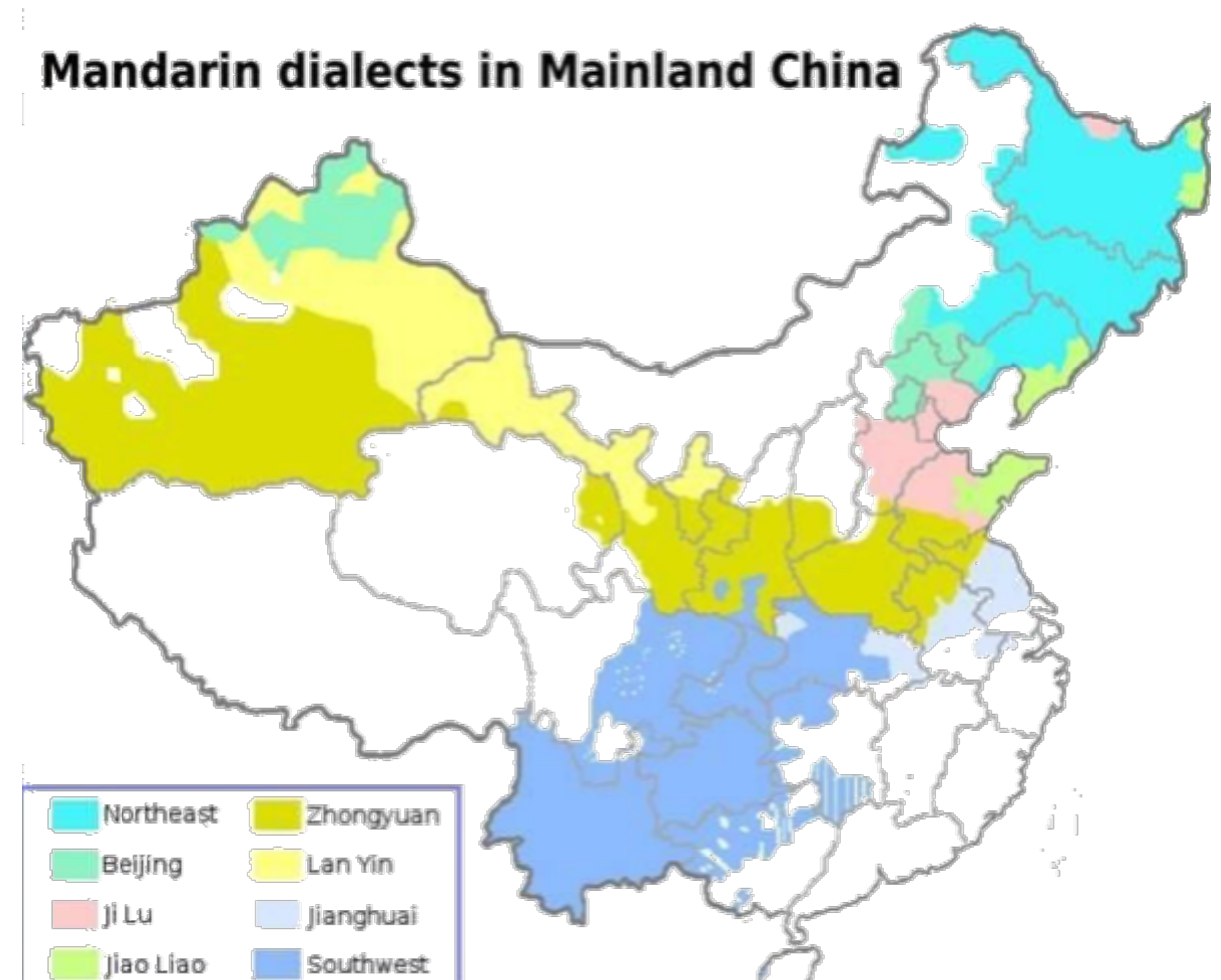
## Significance

There is no exact standard in the Chinese language for pronunciation or grammar. The language consists of many dialects consistent by region. "Mandarin Chinese" refers to a specific group of these dialects, and "standard Mandarin" is the chief dialect spoken in Beijing. Chinese who speak in other dialects know Mandarin and speak it as a second language. Therefore, Mandarin Chinese has the largest number of speakers of any language in the world.

## Geography

### Geography of Mandarin dialects

The Mandarin dialects are indigenous to northern and most of southwestern China. As depicted on the map, Mandarin is spoken in the far northwestern and northeastern regions, but not particularly in the central northern area. Mandarin is also the official language of Taiwan and one of the four official languages of Singapore.



## History

China's geographical regions led to the creation of the different dialects of the Chinese language. The regions separated by mountains and valleys developed their own dialect, but could not influence this dialect in other regions because the land's topography isolated them. The plains regions developed the Mandarin dialects, and due to the flatness of the land, the dialect could easily spread across the plains. The empire in the 17th century attempted to make the Beijing dialect the only dialect spoken all across China, but the movement failed. People in every region spoke their own dialect without a unified language up until the 20th century when the Chinese government declared the Beijing dialect as the standard Mandarin and as the official language of the People's Republic. As a result, the dialect spread to other regions as a second language.

# Warm-up

## Hello

Àishā : Nǐhǎo!

爱莎 : 你好!

*Hello!*

Ālǐ : Nǐhǎo!

阿里 : 你好!

*Hello!*

## Thanks

Ālǐ : Xièxie.

阿里 : 谢谢。

*Thanks.*

Àishā : Bú kèqì.

爱莎 : 不 客气。

*You're welcome.*

## Goodbye

Ālǐ : Zàijiàn.

阿里 : 再见。

*Goodbye.*

Àishā : Zàijiàn.

爱莎 : 再见。

*Goodbye.*





# First Part: Shopping

## 1.1 Phrases For Customer



kèrén  
客人  
*Customer*

Wǒ yào kàn ...  
我 要 看 ...  
*I want to see...*

Wǒ yào  
我 要  
*I want*

Zhège duōshǎo qián?  
这 个 多 少 钱 ?  
*How much money is this?*

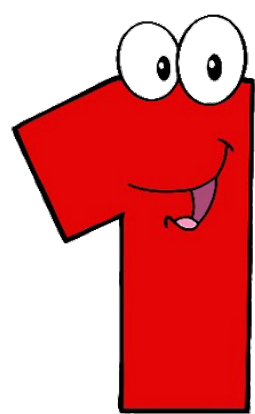
zhège  
这 个  
*this one*

nàge  
那 个  
*that one*



# First Part: Shopping

## 1.2 Numbers (1-10)



yī

一



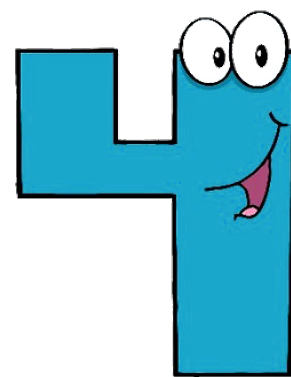
èr

二



sān

三



sì

四



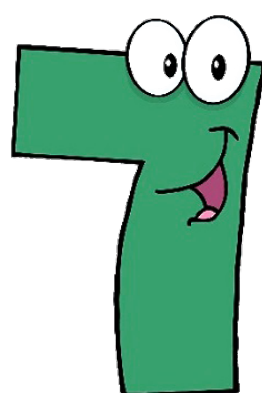
wǔ

五



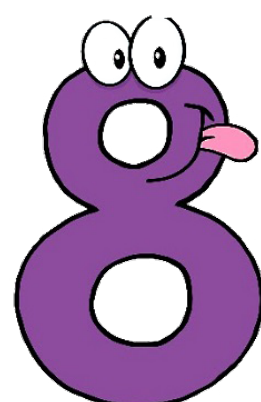
liù

六



qī

七



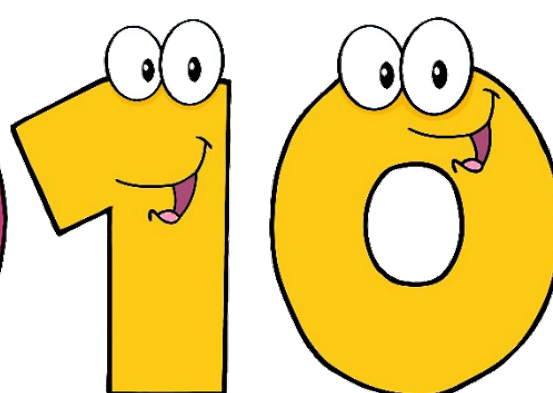
bā

八



jiǔ

九



shí

十

## 1.3 Price

bǎi

百

shí

十

kuài

块

\_\_\_\_\_



# Second Part: Bargaining

## Bargaining

Kèrén : Lǎobǎn, zhège duōshǎo qián?

客人 : 老板, 这个 多少 钱?

*Boss, this one how much?*

Lǎobǎn : Wǔshí kuài.

老板 : 五十 块。

*\$50 in total.*

Kèrén : Tài guì le!

客人 : 太 贵 了!

*Too expensive!*

: Lǎobǎn hěn **shuài / piàoliang**, kěyǐ **piányi** yìdiǎn ma?

: 老板 很 帅 / 漂亮, 可以 便宜 一点 吗?

*Boss very **handsome / beautiful**, Can it be **cheaper**?*

Lǎobǎn : Hǎo la hǎo la, **suàn** nǐ sānshíwǔ kuài ba!

老板 : 好 啦 好 啦, 算 你 三十五 块 吧!

*Alright alright, **count** you \$35 lah!*

Kèrén : Xièxie lǎobǎn, lǎobǎn hengheng!

客人 : 谢谢 老板, 老板 hengheng !

*Thank you boss, wish boss hengheng (prosperity)!*







# Song Lyrics:

Song Title : Duōshǎo qián?  
多少 钱 ?  
*How much money?*

Lyrics:  
Lǎobǎn, duōshǎo qián? (x3)  
老板, 多少 钱 ?  
*Boss, how much money?*

Zhège (x4) duōshǎo qián?  
这个 多少 钱 ?  
*This one how much money?*

Yī kuài (x3) qián.  
一 块 钱 。  
*1 dollar.*

Liǎng kuài (x3) qián.  
两 块 钱 。  
*2 dollars.*

Sān kuài (x3) qián.  
三 块 钱 。  
*3 dollars.*

Hěnduō (x3) qián.  
很 多 钱 。  
*A lot of money.*

